

ChatGPT Starter Guide for Teachers

New to ChatGPT? Start with real classroom problems, not complicated prompting. This one-page guide gives teachers practical examples they can use right away.

A simple formula: Tell ChatGPT your grade or subject, what you are trying to do, what is not working, and any limits you have.

10 useful things to ask

1. Teach it another way

"I am teaching 3rd grade multiplication. Some students do not understand equal groups. Give me another way to explain it, with a quick example I can use tomorrow."

2. Plan for confusion

"What are 3 common misunderstandings students might have about this lesson, and how can I respond to each one?"

3. Make a lesson fit the time

"I have 35 minutes for this lesson. What is essential, what can I shorten, and what should I save for later?"

4. Check understanding

"Give me 5 quick checks for understanding I can use during a lesson on fractions. Keep each one under 2 minutes."

5. Support a struggling learner

"Give me 3 ways to scaffold this task without giving away the answer. Keep the grade-level goal the same."

6. Create examples and non-examples

"Give me 4 examples, 2 non-examples, and one common mistake for the concept of area."

7. Make directions clearer

"Rewrite these directions so an 8-year-old can understand them. Keep them short and in numbered steps."

8. Draft a parent message

"Help me write a calm, factual parent message about a classroom concern. Keep it positive, clear, and focused on next steps."

9. Turn notes into a plan

"Here are anonymous observations about a class pattern. What patterns do you notice, and what are 3 low-prep things I could try next?"

10. Prep yourself before teaching

"Explain this topic to me like I am teaching it tomorrow. What do I need to understand well, and what questions might students ask?"

Privacy first

Keep student names and other private student information out of AI tools. Do not include student names, ID numbers, addresses, contact information, or other details that could identify a child. Be especially careful with IEP or 504 information, health or disability information, discipline details, grades, family circumstances, and other sensitive records. Use generic descriptions such as "a student," "one learner," or "a parent." Follow your school or district's AI and student-data policies.

**No hype. No complicated tech talk.
Just simple, practical ways teachers can use AI.**

One more tip: Treat the first answer as a draft. Say things like "make it shorter," "give me another example," "make this appropriate for 3rd grade," or "that will not work in my classroom because..." The conversation is the skill.